

CHAPTER 5

Footprints without Feet

NCERT Exercise Solutions

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✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡 answers are samples: write your own.

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⭐ Footprints without Feet · Read and Find Out (1)

1 **How did the invisible man first become visible?**

✔ ANSWER

He slipped into a big London store for warmth. After closing time he put on warm clothes, shoes, an overcoat and a wide-brimmed hat, and so he became **a fully dressed and visible person**.

2 **Why was he wandering the streets?**

✔ ANSWER

Griffin had set fire to his landlord's house in revenge. To get away without being seen, he had to **remove his clothes**. So he became **a homeless wanderer**, without clothes, without money and quite invisible.

⭐ Footprints without Feet · Read and Find Out (2)

1 **Why does Mrs Hall find the scientist eccentric?**

✔ ANSWER

Griffin had an uncommon appearance (bandages, dark glasses, false nose, side-whiskers). He did not want to talk and said he had come to Iping for **solitude** and did not wish to be disturbed in his work. He also had strange habits and an **irritable temper**. So Mrs Hall thought he was an eccentric scientist.

2 **What curious episode occurs in the study?**

✔ ANSWER

Early one morning the clergyman and his wife heard noises in the study and the **chink of money** being taken from the desk. The clergyman flung open the door with a poker, but the room **appeared empty**. They searched under the desk, behind the curtains and up the chimney, yet the desk was open and the **housekeeping money was missing**.

3 **What other extraordinary things happen at the inn?**

✔ ANSWER

- Mrs Hall and her husband found the scientist's door open, and his clothes and bandages lying about the empty room.
- Mrs Hall heard a **sniff** close to her ear; the **hat** on the bedpost leapt up and dashed into her face.

- The **bedroom chair** sprang into the air, charged at her, pushed them both out and seemed to slam and lock the door.
- Later Griffin threw off his bandages, whiskers, spectacles and nose, and people saw a **headless man**.
- He became invisible, fought the constable Jaffers, knocked him unconscious and escaped.

🤔 Footprints without Feet · Think about it

1 **"Griffin was rather a lawless person." Comment.**

✔ ANSWER

Griffin was a brilliant scientist, but he had no respect for law or for other people. He misused his discovery for selfish ends.

- He **set fire** to his landlord's house in revenge.
- He **broke open boxes** in a London store and took clothes and food.
- He **callously attacked** the shopkeeper in Drury Lane from behind and **robbed** him of all his money.
- He **stole** the housekeeping money from the clergyman's desk in Iping.
- He frightened Mrs Hall and **knocked the constable Jaffers unconscious** to avoid arrest.

Thus, the statement is true: Griffin was a lawless person who used his invisibility to commit crimes.

2 **How would you assess Griffin as a scientist?**

✔ ANSWER

As a scientist, Griffin was **brilliant**. He carried out experiment after experiment and finally discovered how to make the human body **transparent** by swallowing certain rare drugs. This was a remarkable discovery.

But he was not a good human being. Instead of using his discovery for the good of mankind, he **misused** it to steal, rob, hurt people and escape the law. He was also quick-tempered, irritable and lonely.

So Griffin was a genius in science but a **failure as a responsible person**; his great talent was wasted on crime.

⭐ Footprints without Feet · Talk about it

1 **Would you like to become invisible? What advantages and disadvantages do you foresee, if you did?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

(Discussion – sample points)

I would like to become invisible only for a short time, for good work.

Advantages:

- I could help the police catch criminals or find out secrets that harm society.
- I could move about freely and watch things without being disturbed.

Disadvantages:

- Like Griffin, I would feel cold without clothes and could not live a normal life.
- People might fear me; I would feel lonely and could be tempted to misuse the power.
- Accidents could happen, as no one could see me on the road.

2 **Are there forces around us that are invisible, for example, magnetism? Are there aspects of matter that are 'invisible' or not visible to the naked eye? What would the world be like if you could see such forces or such aspects of matter?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

(Discussion – sample points)

- Yes. **Gravity, magnetism, electricity, air pressure** and **radio waves** are invisible forces around us.
- Atoms, molecules, germs (bacteria, viruses), gases like oxygen and the air itself are not visible to the naked eye.

- If we could see them, the world would look crowded and confusing: waves, germs and air particles would be everywhere. It might be frightening, but it could also help us – for example, we could see germs and stay clean, or see harmful gases and avoid them.

3 **What makes glass or water transparent (what is the scientific explanation for this)? Do you think it would be scientifically possible for a man to become invisible, or transparent? (Keep in mind that writers of science fiction have often turned out to be prophetic in their imagination!)**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

(Discussion – sample points)

- Glass and water are transparent because they **let light pass through** them. They do not absorb or scatter much visible light, so we can see through them.
- The human body absorbs and reflects light (because of skin, blood and other tissues), so it is not transparent.
- Today it is not possible for a man to become invisible. But scientists are working on special materials ("invisibility cloaks") that bend light around objects. Science fiction has often come true (e.g. submarines, rockets), so it may become possible in the future.

🎉 **Chapter 5 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**